

Hazel the Hamster Shares a Nibble

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Hazel was a chubby golden hamster. She lived in a burrow under the sunflower patch. Hazel loved sunflower seeds. She stuffed them in her cheeks. Left cheek full. Right cheek full. She looked like a fluffy balloon. One morning, Hazel found the biggest seed head ever. It was full of plump seeds. Crack, munch, stuff! She filled both cheeks to bursting. She could barely close her mouth. Hazel felt proud. "All mine," she squeaked.



Her friend Nico the newt came by. He looked hungry. His tummy rumbled. Rumble rumble. "Hello, Hazel," said Nico. "Do you have a seed to spare?" "I have not eaten all day." Hazel felt nervous. Her cheeks were so full. But they were HER seeds. What if she gave one away? What if there were not enough? Hazel shook her head. "I need them all," she mumbled. Nico's smile faded. He turned to go. Hazel felt sad. She did not like saying no.



Then Hazel remembered her mother's words. "One nibble shared is double the yum," Mama used to say. "One nibble shared is double the yum." Hazel said it out loud. It sounded squeaky through full cheeks. "One nibble shared is double the yum." It became her sharing song. "One nibble shared is double the yum." Hazel pushed one seed from her cheek. Plip! It landed in front of Nico. "For you," she said. Nico's eyes lit up. "Really?" he asked. Hazel nodded. She pushed out another seed. And another. Nico munched happily. Crunch crunch. Hazel felt warm. She felt happy. Sharing felt better than stuffing.



Can you share a nibble like Hazel? Pretend to hold a seed. Now give it away! One nibble shared is double the yum. Nico shared his dewdrop drink with Hazel. Slurp! They sat under the sunflowers together. Hazel still had plenty of seeds. Her cheeks were full, but her heart was fuller. They watched the bees buzz by. They watched the clouds drift. "One nibble shared is double the yum," they sang. It was true. Everything tasted yummier together.



That evening, the sunflowers nodded in the breeze. Hazel curled in her soft burrow. Nico slept in the moss nearby. "Thank you for sharing," whispered Nico. "You are welcome," yawned Hazel. She patted her happy tummy. Pat pat pat. The burrow was warm and dark. The night was quiet and still. And Hazel slept with the sweetest dreams.

***Moral:** A shared nibble tastes twice as sweet.*

The End